RPG EXCELLENCE
MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS & BUSINESS ASSURANCE
SAFETY • ENVIRONMENT • SECURITY • RESILIENCE

PUBLICATION 02 / COLLECTED EDITION

ISO 9001:2026 TECHNICAL INSIGHTS

& POSTER COLLECTION

The complete published series
Clauses 4 to 10

7 technical articles
7 original chapter covers
21 supporting posters

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www.rpgexcellence.com

About this collection

This publication brings together the seven RPG Excellence Technical Insight articles previously published in the Decoding ISO 9001:2026 series. It combines the articles, their original cover graphics and twenty-one supporting posters in one reference for quality managers, leaders and internal auditors.

The central question throughout is whether evidence supports the decision. Each chapter connects the relevant requirements with operating judgements, a hypothetical example and a management or auditor challenge. The posters provide concise prompts for team discussion and awareness.

How to use the collection

Read a chapter, choose a relevant poster and discuss one real process or decision with the people involved. Follow the evidence into the work, agree a proportionate response and review the result. The posters supplement the articles; they are not exhaustive clause checklists.

Publication information

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All worked examples and associated figures are hypothetical. Practical methods, measures and exercises are recommendations unless the text identifies a requirement. Poster photography is generated illustrative artwork and does not depict actual RPG customer events. Refer to the source section for the technical basis.

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Day 1 Clause 4

Context



The business assumptions behind every quality failure

Technical Insight and three supporting posters

Read the article, then use the posters to discuss evidence and decisions in your own organisation. The poster prompts are practical guidance, rather than additional universal requirements.

Day 1 Clause 4 Context

The business assumptions behind every quality failure

A supplier changes its manufacturing route. A customer introduces a tighter acceptance criterion. A business accepts more work without adding technical capacity.

Weeks later, the quality team investigates late delivery, rework or an unreliable result. The investigation starts at the failed process. The weakness may have started much earlier: the business changed, but the management system continued to operate on yesterday's assumptions.

Clause 4 is where those assumptions should be examined. Its four parts connect operating conditions, relevant requirements, system boundaries and process control. The technical test is whether those decisions influence how work is accepted, performed and released.

4.1 - Identify what could change the result

The organisation must identify relevant internal and external issues, decide whether climate change is relevant, and monitor and review information about those issues.

Relevance is the key judgement. A long list of economic, technological and environmental topics proves little unless it explains an effect on the quality management system's intended results.

Consider a testing business expanding into a method with tighter environmental tolerances. Hotter operating conditions may affect temperature control, equipment stability and turnaround commitments. The useful analysis connects the issue to a process, an acceptance boundary and a decision about capability or resources.

A SWOT or PESTLE exercise can organise that thinking. Neither format is prescribed by Clause 4.1. My practical recommendation is to give each material issue an owner, an evidence source and a review trigger. Those are implementation choices, rather than extra requirements imposed by the clause.

An auditor should follow a changed issue into the operating system: what changed in planning, competence, capacity or acceptance criteria because the business recognised it?

Climate is not an entirely new 2026 requirement. Explicit consideration entered ISO 9001 through Amendment 1:2024. Its quality implications must be evaluated; ISO 9001 does not automatically impose an environmental management system or a universal carbon-reduction target.

4.2 - Translate relevant expectations into controlled requirements

The supplied 2026 text makes the decision sequence explicit: identify relevant interested parties, identify their relevant requirements, and determine which requirements the QMS will address. Keep that information under review.

These are three different judgements. A stakeholder list is only the starting point.

A customer's request for shorter lead times may affect capacity planning. A regulator's applicable product requirement may affect technical acceptance and release. A critical external provider's handling conditions may affect the validity of purchased material or services.

The strongest evidence connects a requirement to its source, the affected process and the control used to meet it. A relevant legal or contractual obligation cannot simply be discarded because it is inconvenient.

Be careful with broad sustainability claims. Evaluate the actual requirement and its relationship to conformity, customer satisfaction or other intended QMS results. Do not assume that every ESG expectation becomes a mandatory ISO 9001 control.

4.3 - Define the boundary without hiding responsibility

The QMS scope uses context, relevant requirements, and the products and services provided to establish boundaries and applicability. It must be documented, identify the types of products and services covered, and justify requirements judged inapplicable.

A scope should let a customer or auditor understand what the system actually covers. Relevant activities and locations may need explanation, especially where different sites perform different parts of the work. Annex A.4.3 helps interpret that boundary.

Outsourcing requires particular care. Sending design or inspection to another organisation does not, by itself, remove the responsibility attached to the product or service supplied to the customer. Applicability follows the activity and responsibility; it does not follow the location of a job title on an organisation chart.

Distinguish the QMS scope, a certification body's certificate wording, and the scope of an individual audit. They serve related purposes, but should not be treated as interchangeable.

4.4 - Control the handovers that organisation charts conceal

Subclause 4.4.1 requires a functioning system of connected processes: defined inputs and outputs, interactions, operating criteria, resources, authority, performance evaluation, risk and opportunity responses, and improvement.

The handover is often the revealing place to look. Sales may regard an order as complete while operations still lacks the information needed to deliver it correctly. Each department can meet a local target while the customer experiences failure.

Take one requirement from enquiry to release. At each handover, establish what must be present, who accepts it, what authorises an exception and how performance is evaluated. A process map supports this analysis; it does not replace operating evidence.

Subclause 4.4.2 addresses the documented information needed to support process operation and demonstrate that planned arrangements are followed. The necessary detail depends on the process. A low-complexity activity may need concise controls; a high-consequence technical decision may need more explicit instructions and retained evidence.

Annex A.4 is explanatory guidance. Use it to interpret the requirements, without treating its commentary as additional auditable obligations.

A worked example: the missing-information problem

The following figures are hypothetical, illustrating analysis rather than reporting RPG customer results.

A service team reviews 20 delayed jobs. Twelve entered operations without required customer information. Missing information appears in 60% of the delayed-job sample. That does not establish its prevalence across all orders, or prove it caused every delay.

The team traces the chain: growth in a new service changes the business context; its customer-information requirements need clearer definition; contract review and delivery share responsibility; the handover lacks an effective acceptance check.

The response is a controlled acceptance check, a named owner and a route for approving exceptions. The team compares the next period using consistent definitions: missing-information holds per 100 accepted jobs, first-time acceptance and on-time delivery. It also checks job mix and whether extra checking creates another bottleneck.

The revised form is evidence of implementation. Better results across comparable work provide evidence about effectiveness.

The management test for this week

Select one recent change: a new customer condition, supplier change, capacity constraint or site move. Ask its owner to trace it through all four parts of Clause 4.

For that sample, identify the evidence that explains the issue, the relevant requirement, the boundary affected, the changed process control and the result reviewed. An untraceable link is a reason to investigate, not an automatic finding of nonconformity.

Clause 4 earns its place in the management system when leaders can explain how a changed assumption became a changed control, and what happened afterwards.

Which recent business change has genuinely changed one of your quality controls - and what evidence shows the change worked?

DAY 1 / CLAUSE 4 / SUPPORTING POSTER 01

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 4

THE BUSINESS CHANGED. DID THE QMS FOLLOW?

IDENTIFY THE ISSUE

Consider changes that can affect intended QMS results.

FOLLOW THE EFFECT

Connect the issue to capability, resources or process controls.

REVIEW THE RESPONSE

Check whether the changed control achieved its purpose.



Context matters when it changes an operating decision.

Practical guidance supporting Clause 4.1.

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DAY 1 / CLAUSE 4 / SUPPORTING POSTER 02

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 4

A STAKEHOLDER LIST IS THE START

RELEVANT PARTIES
Identify who is relevant to the QMS.

RELEVANT REQUIREMENTS
Understand the requirements that matter to intended results.

QMS RESPONSE
Determine which requirements the QMS will address and keep them under review.



Connect the requirement to its source, process and control.

Practical guidance supporting Clause 4.2. Applicable legal and contractual obligations still apply.

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DAY 1 / CLAUSE 4 / SUPPORTING POSTER 03

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 4

CHECK THE BOUNDARIES. TRACE THE HANDOVERS.

DEFINE THE SCOPE

Explain the boundaries, covered outputs and applicability.

CONNECT THE PROCESSES

Identify inputs, outputs, responsibilities and operating controls.

FOLLOW ONE REQUIREMENT

Trace the evidence from enquiry to release.



Outsourcing alone does not remove responsibility.

Practical guidance supporting Clauses 4.3 and 4.4.

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Day 2 Clause 5

Leadership



What leaders authorise under pressure

Technical Insight and three supporting posters

Read the article, then use the posters to discuss evidence and decisions in your own organisation. The poster prompts are practical guidance, rather than additional universal requirements.

Day 2 Clause 5 Leadership

What leaders authorise under pressure

An order is due to leave this afternoon. The customer expects delivery. The operations team has completed the work, but the inspection evidence is incomplete.

Someone asks whether the paperwork can follow tomorrow.

At that moment, the organisation's quality policy becomes a practical leadership decision. Who can stop release? Who owns the customer conversation? Who provides the resources needed to resolve the problem? What happens to the person who raises the concern?

Clause 5 is tested in decisions like these. It connects leadership accountability, customer focus, policy and authority. ISO's public explanation of the 2026 edition highlights the stronger emphasis on quality culture, ethical behaviour and strategic alignment.

5.1.1 - Accountability must reach the operating decision

Top management remains accountable for the effectiveness of the quality management system. Its responsibilities include aligning policy and objectives with strategic direction, integrating quality requirements into business processes, providing resources and supporting people to achieve the system's intended results.

That responsibility extends to promoting improvement, the process approach, risk and opportunity thinking, quality culture and ethical behaviour. These ideas need to work together.

Consider a leadership team that sets an ambitious growth target but leaves technical review capacity unchanged. If orders routinely bypass review to meet the target, the weakness involves business planning, resources and authority as well as individual decisions.

Delegating quality activities is appropriate. Accountability for whether those arrangements work remains with top management. A quality manager can report a capacity shortfall; the leadership team must decide how to address it and evaluate the consequences.

The useful evidence is a decision trail: the issue presented, the information considered, the resource or priority decision, the person responsible and the result subsequently reviewed. A specific decision-log format is my recommendation, rather than a document prescribed by Clause 5.

Make quality culture observable

The 2026 requirement explicitly addresses promoting quality culture and ethical behaviour. Annex A.5 explains their connection with visible leadership involvement, values and everyday actions. The annex helps interpretation; it adds no separate requirements.

Audit the conditions in which people make decisions. Can a technician challenge an unsupported result? Are concerns examined fairly? Do managers apply acceptance criteria consistently when a valuable customer is waiting? Are performance reports accurate when the news is unwelcome?

A low number of reported concerns is ambiguous. It may indicate stable processes, limited exposure, weak reporting or reluctance to speak. Corroborate the numbers through interviews, operating records and examples of how leaders responded.

Likewise, a rise in near misses or quality concerns after a reporting initiative does not automatically mean performance has deteriorated. Leaders need to understand what the measure can actually establish before attaching a reward or penalty to it.

5.1.2 - Customer focus includes the requirements behind the promise

Top management must ensure that customer and applicable legal requirements are understood and consistently met, that relevant risks and opportunities are addressed, and that attention to customer satisfaction is maintained.

This calls for more than a favourable survey score. A customer can be satisfied with delivery speed while a mandatory technical requirement remains unmet. Conversely, a decision to delay release may protect the customer's longer-term interests even when it creates immediate dissatisfaction.

The practical test is to connect customer promises with capability and release decisions. Review changes to specifications, recurring concessions, complaints, technical acceptance and delivery commitments together. Leadership needs to understand the trade-offs it is authorising.

5.2.1 - A policy must help leaders choose

The policy must fit the organisation's purpose, provide a basis for objectives, include commitments to applicable requirements and continual improvement, and take account of context and strategic direction.

Its value becomes clearer when priorities compete. If the policy commits the organisation to reliable technical results, what does that imply for inspection capacity, equipment availability and acceptance of additional work?

A concise policy can be effective. The audit challenge is to find the connection between its commitments and actual objectives, resources and decisions. Repeating broad aspirations on a document does not establish that connection.

5.2.2 - Communication must reach application

The policy must be available as documented information, communicated internally, made available to interested parties where appropriate, and implemented, understood and applied within the organisation.

An induction record establishes that communication occurred. It does not, on its own, establish understanding or application.

Ask people to explain what the policy means for their work. An order reviewer might describe challenging an unrealistic promise. A buyer might explain approval of a critical provider. A technician might describe when a result must be withheld. The language can differ while the underlying commitments remain consistent.

5.3 - Responsibility needs usable authority

Relevant roles need assigned and communicated responsibility and authority. This includes QMS conformity, process results, customer focus, performance reporting, improvement opportunities and protection of system integrity during change.

A role profile that makes someone responsible for quality while giving them no route to resolve a conflict deserves examination. Check who can withhold acceptance, escalate a concern, approve a change and commit resources, then compare those arrangements with what happens in practice.

These responsibilities can sit across several roles. Clause 5.3 does not prescribe a particular job title or require one dedicated management representative. Local responsibilities should still form a coherent system.

A worked example: six orders waiting for evidence

This example is hypothetical; the figures are not RPG customer data.

A release queue contains 40 orders. Six lack the inspection evidence required by the planned arrangements. Fifteen per cent of that queue is awaiting evidence. That figure is neither a product-defect rate nor a measure of all orders processed.

Leadership maintains the release hold, assigns competent review capacity and authorises an accurate customer update. The authorised release function then assesses the evidence against applicable criteria. A deadline does not itself authorise release; any permissible deviation requires its own controlled decision under the applicable arrangements.

The team investigates the recurring capacity and handover problem. Follow-up measures include evidence-related holds per 100 completed orders, age of the held orders, recurrence and customer impact. A falling backlog is useful only if acceptance and release controls remain effective.

The leadership test for this week

Sample one recent conflict between delivery pressure and quality requirements. Identify the decision-maker, the evidence available, the authority exercised and the result reviewed. Speak to the employee who raised the concern as well as the person who authorised the response.

My recommendation is to review the age and recurrence of unresolved quality escalations alongside delivery performance. No universal ISO threshold is implied; choose measures and decision points appropriate to the work.

What happened the last time someone in your organisation raised an inconvenient quality concern - and what did your leadership response teach everyone watching?

DAY 2 / CLAUSE 5 / SUPPORTING POSTER 01

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 5

DELIVERY PRESSURE RISES. WHAT DO LEADERS AUTHORISE?

PROTECT THE REQUIREMENT

Connect customer promises with capability and acceptance criteria.

PROVIDE THE RESOURCES

Address the constraints affecting reliable delivery.

FOLLOW THE DECISION

Review the consequences of the priorities and actions authorised.



Delegating quality activities does not remove leadership accountability.

Practical guidance supporting Clauses 5.1.1 and 5.1.2.

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DAY 2 / CLAUSE 5 / SUPPORTING POSTER 02

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 5

SOMEONE RAISES AN INCONVENIENT CONCERN

LISTEN TO THE EVIDENCE

Examine the concern fairly, even when delivery is under pressure.

MAKE EXPECTATIONS VISIBLE

Apply quality commitments and ethical behaviour in everyday decisions.

INTERPRET REPORTING CAREFULLY

Low reporting alone cannot establish a strong quality culture.



What does the leadership response teach everyone watching?

Practical guidance supporting Clause 5.1.1.

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DAY 2 / CLAUSE 5 / SUPPORTING POSTER 03

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 5

RESPONSIBILITY NEEDS USABLE AUTHORITY.

CONNECT POLICY TO WORK

Explain what quality commitments mean for everyday decisions.

CLARIFY THE ROLES

Assign and communicate relevant responsibilities and authority.

TEST THE ARRANGEMENT

Check who can escalate concerns, approve changes and commit resources.



A policy becomes useful when people can apply it.

Practical guidance supporting Clauses 5.2 and 5.3. No particular job title is prescribed.

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Day 3 Clause 6

Planning



Why an opportunity deserves its own decision

Technical Insight and three supporting posters

Read the article, then use the posters to discuss evidence and decisions in your own organisation. The poster prompts are practical guidance, rather than additional universal requirements.

Day 3 Clause 6 Planning

Why an opportunity deserves its own decision

The new reporting system is live. Training is complete. The project dashboard is green.

Three months later, customers still receive corrected reports. Nobody agreed a baseline, defined an acceptable result or checked whether the new system introduced different errors.

This hypothetical organisation completed a project. It has yet to demonstrate that its planning delivered the intended benefit.

Clause 6 connects the organisation's understanding of its circumstances with decisions about action, objectives and change. Its practical value becomes visible when management can explain why it selected an action, how that action reached daily work and what happened afterwards.

1. Start With The Decision - Clause 6.1.1

Planning begins with the issues and relevant requirements considered under Clause 4. A risk list disconnected from that analysis may overlook the conditions most likely to affect results.

Consider a laboratory facing increased demand for shorter reporting times. Customers expect timely, accurate results. Experienced reviewers are already working near capacity. A supplier offers an interface that transfers instrument data directly into the reporting system.

There are several decisions here. Reviewer overload could allow errors to escape. Automated transfer could remove repetitive entry and improve consistency. Implementation could also introduce incorrect field mapping or unsuitable access permissions.

Management needs to understand these different effects before choosing its response. A single entry labelled “digitalisation” would conceal too much.

2. Give Risks And Opportunities Distinct Attention - Clauses 6.1.2 And 6.1.3

The 2026 edition makes the distinction clearer. Risk actions address potential adverse effects on consistent conformity and customer satisfaction. Opportunity actions pursue beneficial effects on those outcomes.

Each needs analysis, evaluation, planned action, integration into QMS processes and an assessment of effectiveness. Risk responses should match the significance of the potential impact. Opportunity actions should suit the organisation's circumstances and support its intended results.

An opportunity therefore deserves more than an optimistic description in a risk register. What benefit is credible? What capability is available? What investment and implementation effort are justified? What would show that pursuing it was worthwhile?

In the laboratory example, managing reviewer overload might involve temporary capacity arrangements and clearer escalation rules. Pursuing automated transfer requires a separate decision about expected benefits, feasibility and controls. The two decisions can support each other without becoming identical.

This does not require two registers. Informative Annex A.6 explains that separate processes can be used; it does not prescribe them. Nor does risk-based thinking require a formal risk-

management methodology. A shared planning record can work if the reasoning, actions and evaluation remain clear.

3. Put The Action Into The Process

“Implement automation” is too broad to tell an operator what changes tomorrow.

A useful implementation plan identifies the affected workflow, responsibilities, checks and escalation arrangements. For the proposed interface, that might include checking transferred fields against source records, controlling mapping changes and defining what happens when transfer fails.

These are practical implementation choices, rather than a universal checklist imposed by Clause 6. Their suitability depends on the work and its consequences. Technical requirements elsewhere in the QMS still apply.

The important distinction is between an action existing on a plan and operating reliably in the process. A purchase order demonstrates procurement. A training attendance sheet demonstrates attendance. Neither, by itself, demonstrates an effective reporting control.

4. Make Objectives Testable - Clauses 6.2.1 And 6.2.2

Quality objectives belong at the functions, levels and processes where they are relevant. They need to align with the policy, consider applicable requirements and relate to conformity and customer satisfaction. They must also be measurable, monitored, communicated, maintained as documented information and updated when appropriate.

“Improve reporting quality” leaves too much interpretation. For a defined pilot, management could instead set an objective to reduce the proportion of issued reports requiring correction from a verified baseline to an agreed level by a specified date.

The accompanying plan should identify the work, resources, responsible person, completion date and evaluation method. Define what counts as a correction, which reports enter the denominator and how different causes will be classified.

Measurable does not mean every objective must be a percentage. The informative guidance allows other suitable forms of evaluation. The test is whether achievement can be assessed consistently, rather than through an impression that things feel better.

5. Interpret The Result Carefully

Suppose the hypothetical pilot records 18 reports requiring correction among 300 issued before the change, and nine among 300 afterwards.

The observed proportion falls from 6% to 3%: a reduction of three percentage points, or 50% relative to the original proportion.

That is promising evidence. It does not, on its own, establish that the interface caused the improvement. Were report complexity, staff experience, checking intensity and correction definitions comparable? Did another intervention occur? Were enough reporting cycles observed to understand normal variation?

Also check what the headline measure could hide. Fewer corrected reports would be a poor outcome if errors were simply detected less often, or if review delays increased sharply.

Before the pilot, management could agree additional checks on error severity, turnaround time and transfer failures. These supporting measures are suggested evaluation choices, not mandatory ISO indicators.

6. Plan The Consequences Of Change - Clause 6.3

A QMS change needs planned consideration of its purpose, potential consequences and effect on the system's integrity. Available resources and information, responsibilities, authority and communication also matter. Planning must consider monitoring, evaluating effectiveness and reviewing results.

For the interface, this could mean confirming who owns the mapping, which information reviewers need, how affected staff learn the revised workflow and how management will review pilot results before wider implementation.

The level of detail should suit the change. A small procedural amendment and a major system migration do not need identical arrangements. Clause 6.3 does not prescribe a universal change form or approval board.

The Auditor'S Technical Challenge

Choose one significant risk response, one pursued opportunity and one recent QMS change. Trace each from the original reason for acting through implementation to the evidence reviewed afterwards.

Ask: “What result demonstrates that this action worked, and what did you decide when you reviewed it?”

An honest answer may be that the evidence is still incomplete. That should lead to an appropriate next step: extend the pilot, revise the action, improve the evaluation or stop an ineffective approach.

Effective planning gives the organisation a defensible basis for deciding what to do next.

DAY 3 / CLAUSE 6 / SUPPORTING POSTER 01

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ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 6

GIVE OPPORTUNITIES THEIR OWN ATTENTION.

UNDERSTAND THE RISK

Evaluate potential adverse effects on intended results.

EVALUATE THE OPPORTUNITY

Assess the desired benefit and whether pursuing it suits the organisation.

PLAN AND REVIEW

Integrate actions into processes and evaluate effectiveness.



Distinct decisions can share one planning record.

Practical guidance supporting Clause 6.1. Separate registers are not required.

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DAY 3 / CLAUSE 6 / SUPPORTING POSTER 02

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 6

MAKE THE OBJECTIVE TESTABLE

DEFINE ACHIEVEMENT

State the result and how it will be evaluated.

PLAN THE WORK

Identify actions, resources, responsibility and completion timing.

MONITOR AND UPDATE

Communicate the objective and review progress using suitable evidence.



Measurable does not mean every objective must be a percentage.

Practical guidance supporting Clause 6.2.

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DAY 3 / CLAUSE 6 / SUPPORTING POSTER 03

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 6

THE CHANGE IS LIVE. DID THE RESULT IMPROVE?

PLAN THE CONSEQUENCES

Consider purpose, system integrity, resources and information.

MAKE RESPONSIBILITY CLEAR

Allocate authority and communicate the change.

EVALUATE THE EFFECT

Monitor effectiveness and review the results.



Implementation is a milestone. The intended benefit still needs evaluation.

Practical guidance supporting Clause 6.3. No universal change form or approval board is prescribed.

www.rpgexcellence.com | Day 3 / Poster 03

Day 4 Clause 7

Support



The certificate is current. Can the task be done correctly?

Technical Insight and three supporting posters

Read the article, then use the posters to discuss evidence and decisions in your own organisation. The poster prompts are practical guidance, rather than additional universal requirements.

Day 4 Clause 7 Support

The certificate is current. Can the task be done correctly?

The training dashboard shows full attendance. The instrument carries a current calibration label. The procedure has been approved.

Yet the operator cannot explain an abnormal reading, the instrument's calibrated range does not cover the task, and the workstation holds yesterday's instruction.

This hypothetical scene exposes a weakness in how organisations evaluate support. Evidence that resources exist is useful. Evidence that they can support the actual work is more persuasive.

Clause 7 connects people, equipment, knowledge and information to dependable performance. Its requirements become meaningful when examined together at the point where a decision affects conformity.

1. Resource The Whole Process - 7.1.1 To 7.1.4

Under 7.1.1, the organisation must identify and provide the resources its QMS needs, considering internal capabilities, constraints and external provision. Clause 7.1.2 specifically addresses the people needed to operate and control processes and implement the system effectively.

A department may have enough staff to perform tests but insufficient capacity to review results. Capacity decisions should therefore consider the complete process, including its controls. A workload model or deputy arrangement can help; neither is a prescribed document title.

Clause 7.1.3 requires suitable infrastructure to be provided and maintained. Infrastructure can include software and communications supporting remote work, as well as premises and equipment. Ask what happens when a connection fails or a workstation cannot access required information.

Clause 7.1.4 addresses the environment needed for process operation and conformity. Physical conditions may matter, but social and psychological conditions can also affect work. The explanatory examples do not impose a universal programme of environmental measurements. Determine what is relevant to the process, then provide and maintain it.

2. Check Suitability Before Trusting Status - 7.1.5.1 And 7.1.5.2

When monitoring or measurement verifies conformity, 7.1.5.1 requires resources that support dependable results, suit the activity and remain fit for use. Appropriate documented evidence of that fitness must be available.

A calibration label alone cannot answer whether an instrument covers the required range or has adequate capability for the acceptance decision. Those questions need a technical evaluation suited to the application.

Clause 7.1.5.2 adds traceability controls when traceability is required or considered essential to confidence in results. These include calibration or verification arrangements, suitable reference standards, identifiable status and protection against changes or deterioration that could invalidate results.

If equipment is unsuitable, the organisation must assess whether previous results were affected and act as necessary. Recalibrating the instrument addresses its future use. It does not settle the validity of earlier decisions.

The standard does not prescribe annual calibration for every instrument. Intervals and controls need a defensible basis appropriate to the requirement and use.

3. Keep Knowledge Usable - 7.1.6

The organisation must identify the knowledge needed for its processes and QMS results, retain it, apply it and share it where needed. Changing needs also require consideration of additional knowledge and updates.

A repository can support this requirement, but uploading lessons learned does not demonstrate their application. Consider the specialist who recognises a misleading signal through experience. If that person leaves, can another competent colleague recognise the condition and make the correct decision?

Practical responses might include guided practice, worked examples and technical handovers. Choose the means according to the knowledge at risk.

4. Distinguish Competence From Attendance - 7.2

Clause 7.2 requires defined competence needs, competent people and appropriate documented evidence. Where action is needed to acquire competence, its effectiveness must be evaluated. The scope includes relevant work performed under the organisation's control, including externally engaged people.

Attendance records show who attended. Qualifications and experience provide other evidence. Their adequacy depends on the task: a certificate may need to be supplemented by observed application or assessment of judgement.

Hypothetical worked example: forty operators attend training on a revised inspection method. Thirty-two meet the agreed practical assessment criteria at the first attempt.

Attendance is 100%. Initially demonstrated competence against those criteria is 80%. The remaining eight require appropriate action; this result does not establish that they are incapable of every task.

Management chooses supervised practice and reassessment before independent work on the revised method. That authorisation arrangement is a practical control selected for this example, rather than a universal form required by Clause 7.

If all eight subsequently meet the criteria, the evidence supports competence for the assessed scope. It does not establish permanent competence across every possible condition. Reconsider evidence when tasks, technology or performance change.

5. Test Awareness Through Decisions - 7.3

People need awareness of the policy, relevant objectives, their contribution to QMS effectiveness, the consequences of failing requirements, and organisational quality culture

and ethical behaviour. ISO identifies the culture and ethics emphasis as a feature of the 2026 revision.

Ask an operator what they would do if asked to record an inspection they did not witness. Their reasoning can reveal more than the ability to repeat a policy statement. Scenario discussion is a suggested assessment method, not an additional mandated examination.

6. Make Communication Reach Its Purpose - 7.4

The organisation must determine relevant internal and external communications: subject, timing, audience, method and responsibility.

For a revised inspection method, sending an email may be suitable for some recipients. Others may need a shift briefing or contractor instruction. Where consequences warrant it, checking understanding is a sensible control. Clause 7.4 does not universally require signed acknowledgement of every message.

7. Control Information Through Its Life - 7.5.1 To 7.5.3.2

Clause 7.5.1 covers information required by the standard and information the organisation determines necessary for an effective system. Clause 7.5.2 requires suitable identification, format, review and approval when information is created or updated.

Under 7.5.3.1, information must be suitable and available when needed, with adequate protection. Clause 7.5.3.2 addresses relevant lifecycle controls, including access, storage, changes, retention and disposal. Necessary external information also needs control, and evidence of conformity needs protection against unintended alteration.

Sample the workstation, not just the document register. Can the user retrieve the current instruction? Can unauthorised changes alter the evidence? Retaining an obsolete version for historical purposes should not allow it to guide current work accidentally.

The Management Takeaway

Within 30 days, sample ten significant tasks. Check each for demonstrated competence, suitable resources and current information. Report how many meet all three checks, alongside the gaps and assigned actions. This is a recommended management exercise, not an ISO target; ten samples cannot establish organisation-wide conformity.

An auditor can trace one task through assessment records, resource suitability evidence, knowledge transfer, interviews and information access. The challenge is whether these sources support the same conclusion.

Which task in your organisation looks fully supported on a dashboard, but would become uncertain if its most experienced person were absent tomorrow?

DAY 4 / CLAUSE 7 / SUPPORTING POSTER 01

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 7

ATTENDANCE IS RECORDED. CAN THE TASK BE DONE?

DEFINE THE TASK

Identify the competence needed for the work.

DEMONSTRATE ABILITY

Use suitable evidence of education, training or experience.

CHECK THE RESULT

Evaluate actions taken to acquire competence.



Attendance records show participation. Competence evidence must suit the task.

Practical guidance supporting Clause 7.2.

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DAY 4 / CLAUSE 7 / SUPPORTING POSTER 02

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 7

CALIBRATED. SUITABLE FOR THIS TASK?

CHECK THE APPLICATION

Does the resource suit the range and acceptance decision?

CHECK THE EVIDENCE

Is appropriate evidence of fitness for purpose available?

CHECK PREVIOUS RESULTS

If equipment is unfit, assess whether earlier results were affected.



A current label supports status. Suitability needs a technical basis.

Practical guidance supporting Clause 7.1.5. Traceability controls apply when required or considered essential.

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DAY 4 / CLAUSE 7 / SUPPORTING POSTER 03

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 7

THE PROCEDURE IS APPROVED. CAN PEOPLE USE IT?

CURRENT INFORMATION

Make suitable information available where and when it is needed.

USABLE KNOWLEDGE

Retain, apply and share knowledge needed for reliable work.

CONTROLLED ACCESS

Protect records and distinguish viewing rights from editing authority.



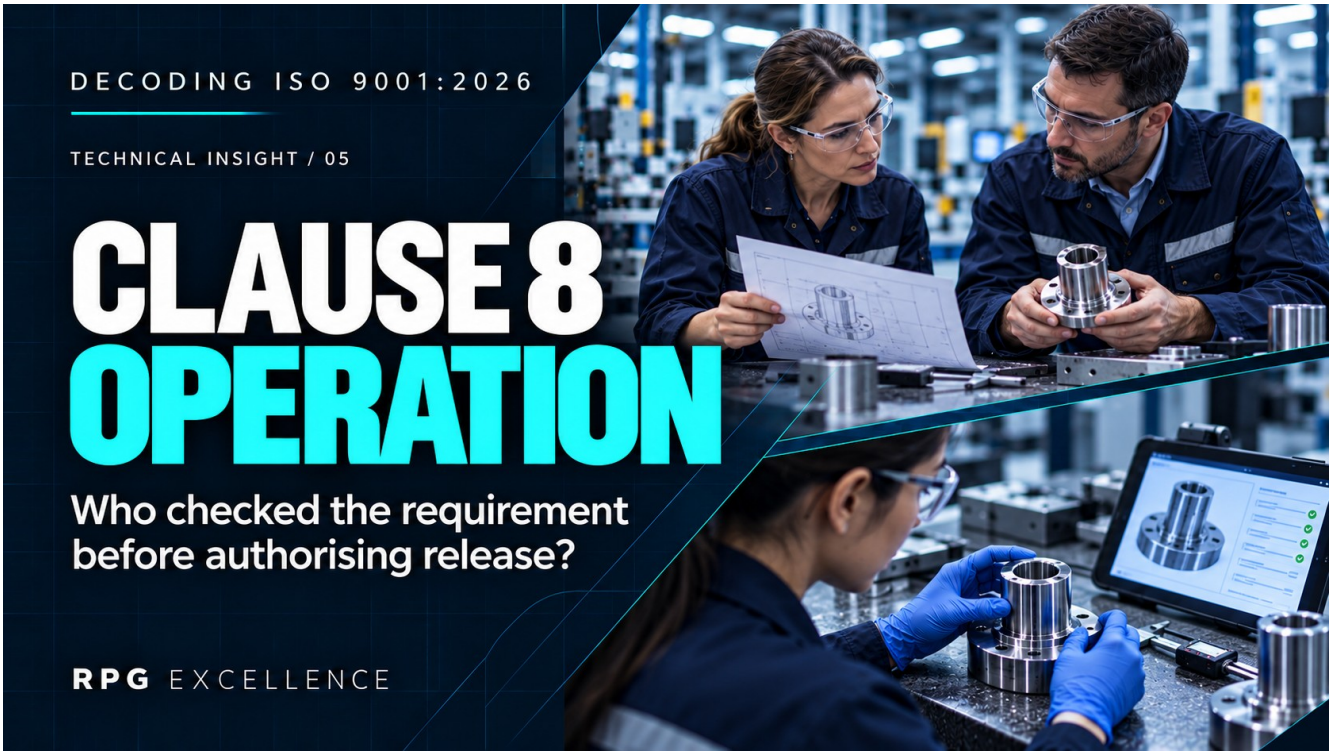
Check the workstation as well as the document register.

Practical guidance supporting Clauses 7.1.6 and 7.5.

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Day 5 Clause 8

Operation



Who checked the requirement before authorising release?

Technical Insight and three supporting posters

Read the article, then use the posters to discuss evidence and decisions in your own organisation. The poster prompts are practical guidance, rather than additional universal requirements.

Day 5 Clause 8 Operation

Who checked the requirement before authorising release?

The customer approved the quotation. The supplier is on the approved list. Production finished on time. Final inspection passed.

Then someone discovers that the acceptance criteria came from an obsolete drawing.

In this hypothetical situation, several activities worked as instructed. The connection between them failed. Clause 8 is valuable because it addresses that connection: from understanding the requirement to controlling delivery, release and exceptions.

BSI describes the 2026 operational changes as comparatively limited. That should encourage careful application of the requirements, rather than an assumption that familiar processes are necessarily effective.

1. Establish The Basis For Control - 8.1

Operational planning must translate requirements and Clause 6 actions into process controls, acceptance criteria, resources and sufficient documented evidence. Planned changes need control; unintended changes need review and appropriate mitigation. External provision also remains controlled.

A useful practical test is to select one order and ask whether its acceptance criteria can be followed through every relevant stage. A process map can help, but the standard does not prescribe a particular mapping format.

2. Understand The Commitment - 8.2.1 To 8.2.4

Clause 8.2.1 covers customer communication about offerings, enquiries and changes, feedback, customer property and relevant contingencies, including disruption. Communication is part of delivery control, not simply a sales activity.

Under 8.2.2, requirements must be defined, including applicable legal requirements and those the organisation considers necessary. Claims about the offering must be achievable.

Clause 8.2.3.1 requires review before commitment: customer requirements, necessary intended-use requirements, organisational requirements, applicable legal requirements and differences from earlier agreements. Resolve differences and confirm requirements when the customer has not documented them. Under 8.2.3.2, appropriate evidence of review and new or changed requirements must be available.

Clause 8.2.4 connects changed requirements to updated information and communication. An approved customer email is insufficient if the instruction reaching production still describes the previous requirement.

3. Make Design Decisions Traceable - 8.3.1 To 8.3.6

Where applicable, 8.3.1 requires a suitable design and development process. Outsourcing design does not automatically remove the organisation's responsibility; applicability needs a justified assessment under the QMS scope requirements.

Clause 8.3.2 addresses planning: stages, responsibilities, resources, interfaces, reviews, verification, validation and evidence, with appropriate customer involvement and consideration of subsequent delivery.

Under 8.3.3, inputs need sufficient clarity and completeness, including relevant performance, experience, legal commitments and failure consequences. Conflicting inputs need resolution.

Clause 8.3.4 distinguishes review, verification and validation. Reviewing design capability, checking outputs against inputs and establishing suitability for intended use answer different questions. Combining activities can be appropriate, provided their purposes are fulfilled and evidence is available.

Outputs under 8.3.5 must support subsequent provision, meet inputs and include relevant acceptance and essential-use information. Clause 8.3.6 requires controlled design changes, with evidence of review, authorisation and action against adverse effects.

4. Control What Others Provide - 8.4.1 To 8.4.3

Clause 8.4.1 requires appropriate provider evaluation, selection, performance monitoring and re-evaluation, with evidence and necessary follow-up. This includes relevant outsourced processes and provision directly to customers on the organisation's behalf.

Clause 8.4.2 requires controls suited to the potential consequences and the effectiveness of the provider's controls. Determine what assurance is needed for both the provider and the supplied output.

Clause 8.4.3 requires adequate requirements to reach the provider, including relevant approval, competence, interface, monitoring and verification arrangements. An approved supplier can still deliver the wrong thing against an incomplete purchase specification.

Supplier certification can contribute evidence. It does not establish conformity of every delivery.

5. Keep Delivery Controlled - 8.5.1 To 8.5.6

Clause 8.5.1 requires controlled production or service conditions, as applicable: suitable instructions, resources, people, infrastructure, checks, human-error prevention and delivery arrangements. Where subsequent monitoring or measurement cannot verify the output, process capability needs validation and periodic revalidation.

Clause 8.5.2 covers necessary identification, inspection status and, when required, unique traceability supported by evidence. A label identifying an item does not necessarily preserve its processing history.

Under 8.5.3, customer and provider property needs care and protection, with reporting and evidence when it is lost, damaged or unsuitable. Property can include data and intellectual material.

Clause 8.5.4 requires preservation sufficient to maintain conformity. Correctly produced work can still be compromised during storage, transport or digital transmission.

Clause 8.5.5 addresses required post-delivery activities, considering legal obligations, consequences, intended use and lifetime, customer requirements and feedback. Clause 8.5.6 requires controlled operational changes and evidence of review, authorisation and resulting actions.

6. Make Release A Supported Decision - 8.6

Planned verification must establish that requirements have been met. Release normally follows satisfactory completion, with the clause allowing an appropriately approved exception involving the customer where applicable. Evidence must support conformity to acceptance criteria and identify who authorised release.

That exception does not provide permission to disregard applicable legal obligations. A release signature should connect to the evidence supporting the actual decision.

7. Control The Exception - 8.7.1 And 8.7.2

Nonconforming outputs need identification and control against unintended use or delivery, including problems discovered after delivery. Responses depend on the nature and consequences: correction, containment, suspension, customer notification or authorised concession may be appropriate.

After correction, conformity needs verification. Documented evidence must describe the problem, action, concessions and decision authority. Correcting an output under Clause 8.7 is distinct from evaluating corrective action under Clause 10.2.

Hypothetical Worked Example

A manufacturer reviews twenty completed orders. Four used superseded acceptance criteria. All four passed inspection against those criteria.

The observed requirement-transfer failure is 4/20, or 20% of this sample. It is not a demonstrated 20% product defect rate. Technical review is needed to determine actual conformity and any effect on delivered items.

Management contains affected work, checks the potentially affected population, evaluates customer implications and repairs the revision-transfer control. A later sample showing no failures would be encouraging evidence, not proof that recurrence is impossible.

The Management Takeaway

Within 30 days, trace ten completed orders from agreed requirements to release. Report how many retain consistent criteria, appropriate provider controls, controlled changes and supported release decisions. Assign owners and dates for gaps. This is a suggested exercise, not an ISO sample-size requirement.

An auditor should compare contracts, revisions, purchase specifications, inspection results, change approvals and release records. Ask where each consequential decision acquired its authority and evidence.

If your final inspection is excellent, what prevents it from confidently accepting work against the wrong requirement?

DAY 5 / CLAUSE 8 / SUPPORTING POSTER 01

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 8

FINAL INSPECTION PASSED. AGAINST WHICH REQUIREMENT?

AGREED REQUIREMENTS

Confirm the commitment before accepting the work.

CONTROLLED CHANGES

Update information and communicate changed requirements.

CONSISTENT CRITERIA

Trace the agreed requirement into instructions and acceptance checks.



A correct inspection against an obsolete requirement can still support the wrong decision.

Practical guidance supporting Clauses 8.1 and 8.2.

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DAY 5 / CLAUSE 8 / SUPPORTING POSTER 02

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 8

THE SUPPLIER IS APPROVED. IS THIS DELIVERY CONFORMING?

SELECT AND REVIEW

Evaluate providers against their ability to meet requirements.

SPECIFY THE WORK

Communicate adequate requirements and relevant controls.

VERIFY THE OUTPUT

Choose checks suited to the consequences and provider controls.



Supplier approval and acceptance of a delivery are related decisions.

Practical guidance supporting Clause 8.4.

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DAY 5 / CLAUSE 8 / SUPPORTING POSTER 03

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 8

RELEASE NEEDS SUPPORTING EVIDENCE

CHECK THE CRITERIA

Complete planned verification against applicable requirements.

IDENTIFY THE AUTHORITY

Record who authorises release and the evidence supporting it.

CONTROL EXCEPTIONS

Control nonconforming outputs and verify conformity after correction.



Trace the release decision back to the requirement and its verification.

Practical guidance supporting Clauses 8.6 and 8.7. Any exception needs appropriate authority and customer involvement where applicable.

www.rpgexcellence.com | Day 5 / Poster 03

Day 6 Clause 9

Performance evaluation



The dashboard is green. What decision does the evidence support?

Technical Insight and three supporting posters

Read the article, then use the posters to discuss evidence and decisions in your own organisation. The poster prompts are practical guidance, rather than additional universal requirements.

Day 6 Clause 9 Performance evaluation

The dashboard is green. What decision does the evidence support?

Complaints have halved. Every scheduled audit is complete. Management review minutes are signed.

The presentation looks reassuring. But deliveries have fallen faster than complaints, auditors repeatedly sample the same straightforward work, and the review records no decision about a growing capacity constraint.

This hypothetical organisation has plenty of information. Its conclusions remain questionable.

Clause 9 connects measurement, customer information, internal audit and management review. The technical challenge is to establish what the evidence supports, where uncertainty remains and what management should do next.

1. Define The Measure Before Trusting The Result - 9.1.1

The organisation must decide what to monitor or measure, how to obtain valid results, when to collect them and when to analyse and evaluate them. It must evaluate QMS performance and effectiveness, with documented evidence of results.

In practice, define the population, reporting period, source, exclusions and calculation before interpreting an indicator. Otherwise two departments can report the same measure using incompatible rules.

For example, does on-time delivery use the original customer commitment or a subsequently revised date? Either calculation might answer a useful question. Presenting one as the other can conceal the effect of repeated rescheduling.

A metric definition sheet is a practical recommendation, not a mandatory ISO document title. Its purpose is consistent interpretation.

2. Listen Beyond The Complaint Log - 9.1.2

Customer satisfaction must be monitored using methods the organisation determines for obtaining and reviewing suitable information.

Complaints are one source. Their absence does not establish satisfaction: a customer may stop ordering rather than complain. Survey results also need interpretation. A high score from a small, unrepresentative group may say little about customers who did not respond.

Useful questions include who provided feedback, which services it concerns, how recent it is and whether other signals agree. Repeat business, customer discussions and delivery feedback can contribute, but none automatically proves satisfaction in isolation.

The standard does not require every organisation to use an annual survey or a particular satisfaction score.

3. Move From Presentation To Evaluation - 9.1.3

Analysis must support evaluation of conformity, satisfaction, QMS performance and effectiveness, implementation of planning, risk responses, opportunity actions, external providers and improvement needs.

These are related subjects with distinct questions. Installing an additional control demonstrates implementation. Evidence that it reduced the targeted exposure supports effectiveness. Launching a new service demonstrates activity; evaluation should test whether the intended opportunity produced the desired result.

Statistical techniques can help when appropriate. Clause 9 does not mandate a control chart for every indicator. Select methods suited to the data and decision, and avoid claiming causation from a simple before-and-after comparison.

Hypothetical Worked Example: Fewer Complaints, Worse Rate

A service provider receives twenty complaints associated with 1,000 completed jobs in one period. In the next comparable period, it receives ten associated with 250 jobs.

Complaint count falls by 50%. Complaints per completed job rise from 2% to 4%: an increase of two percentage points and a doubling of the rate.

Neither figure alone explains why. Check that complaints relate to the stated job populations, definitions remain consistent, reporting delays are accounted for and the service mix is comparable. If multiple complaints can concern one job, this is a complaint frequency, not necessarily the proportion of jobs receiving complaints.

Management should investigate the causes and consequences before claiming improvement. The smaller count could coexist with worsening customer experience. Equally, a changed reporting process could explain part of the increase in the rate.

4. Audit The System That Actually Operates - 9.2.1

Internal audits at planned intervals must provide information about conformity with the organisation's own QMS requirements and the standard, and whether the system is implemented and maintained effectively.

Checking that a procedure exists cannot establish that work follows it. Trace an actual transaction through the relevant controls, then compare records, observations and interviews against the criteria.

Sampling has limits. A sound report identifies the evidence examined and avoids extending a narrow result into an unsupported claim about every site or activity.

5. Make The Programme Responsive - 9.2.2

The audit programme must address frequency, methods, responsibilities, planning and reporting. Process importance, earlier audit results and organisational changes must influence it.

Each audit needs defined objectives, criteria and scope. Auditor selection and conduct must protect objectivity and impartiality. Results must reach relevant managers, and appropriate correction and corrective action must follow without undue delay. Evidence of programme implementation and audit results must be available.

A universal annual audit frequency is not prescribed. A changed process with recurring failures may warrant earlier attention than an unchanged, consistently controlled activity. That judgement should be defensible.

Reporting only the percentage of audits completed can hide weak coverage. Consider whether the programme examined consequential changes and tested previously ineffective controls. These are suggested evaluation questions, not additional mandatory indicators.

6. Review For A Management Purpose - 9.3.1

Top management must review the QMS at planned intervals for continuing suitability, adequacy, effectiveness and alignment with strategic direction.

Those terms require judgement. Is the system still appropriate to the business? Does it provide sufficient arrangements and resources? Are those arrangements achieving intended results?

Review can be integrated into existing governance. A separately titled annual meeting is not compulsory, but the required evaluation still needs to occur.

7. Connect Inputs To Decisions - 9.3.2 And 9.3.3

Review inputs include previous actions, relevant changes in context and interested-party needs, performance trends, improvement opportunities, resource adequacy and the effectiveness of risk and opportunity actions. Performance information covers nonconformities, corrective actions, measurements, audits, satisfaction and feedback, objectives, processes, conformity and external providers.

Under 9.3.3, review results must include decisions concerning improvement opportunities, necessary QMS changes and resource needs, with documented evidence.

An agenda demonstrates intended coverage. It does not establish the quality of the conclusion. Where evidence is incomplete, record that limitation and determine an appropriate response rather than declaring the system effective by default.

The Management Takeaway

Within 30 days, select five significant dashboard claims. For each, verify the source and denominator, document the supported conclusion and identify the resulting decision or justified monitoring response. Report how many of the five meet all three checks. This is a recommended exercise, not an ISO target.

An auditor can follow one claim from raw records through analysis, review and action. Ask what evidence could change management's conclusion, and whether it was sought.

Which green indicator in your organisation would you challenge first if you had to defend the decision behind it?

DAY 6 / CLAUSE 9 / SUPPORTING POSTER 01

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 9

THE DASHBOARD IS GREEN. WHAT DOES THE EVIDENCE SAY?

DEFINE THE MEASURE

Check the population, period, source and calculation.

CHECK THE COMPARISON

Consider volume, reporting delays and changes in the work.

SUPPORT THE CONCLUSION

Explain what the evidence establishes and what remains uncertain.



A favourable headline can hide a worsening rate.

Practical guidance supporting Clauses 9.1.1 and 9.1.3.

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DAY 6 / CLAUSE 9 / SUPPORTING POSTER 02

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 9

THE AUDIT IS COMPLETE. WAS EFFECTIVENESS TESTED?

FOLLOW REAL WORK

Compare records, observations and interviews against the criteria.

PRIORITISE COVERAGE

Consider process importance, previous results and relevant changes.

ACT ON FINDINGS

Report to relevant managers and take appropriate action without undue delay.



Audit completion alone cannot establish effective implementation.

Practical guidance supporting Clause 9.2.
No universal annual audit frequency is prescribed.

www.rpgexcellence.com | Day 6 / Poster 02

DAY 6 / CLAUSE 9 / SUPPORTING POSTER 03



Day 7 Clause 10

Improvement



The action is closed. What has actually improved?

Technical Insight and three supporting posters

Read the article, then use the posters to discuss evidence and decisions in your own organisation. The poster prompts are practical guidance, rather than additional universal requirements.

Day 7 Clause 10 Improvement

The action is closed. What has actually improved?

The revised procedure is approved. The team has completed refresher training. The corrective action record carries a closure date.

Two months later, the same failure occurs on another shift.

This hypothetical case raises an uncomfortable question: did the organisation address the cause, or complete the tasks it had assigned?

Clause 10 connects improvement with a proportionate response to nonconformity. In the supplied 2026 edition, continual improvement sits at 10.1, followed by nonconformity and corrective action at 10.2. Carrying an old 10.3 reference into a revised procedure would miss that structural change.

1. Improvement Needs A Basis - 10.1

The organisation must continually improve how suitable, adequate and effective its QMS is. It must use the results of measurement, analysis, evaluation and management review to identify opportunities, then address them.

The requirement includes improving processes, products and services, considering future needs and expectations, and correcting, preventing or reducing unwanted effects.

That scope extends beyond correcting failures. A process may currently meet requirements but rely on knowledge held by one person. Improving knowledge transfer could support future capability before a failure occurs. A service could also become more useful through an opportunity identified from customer feedback.

The explanatory note recognises different routes to improvement, including incremental changes and larger initiatives. It does not prescribe a particular improvement programme or a monthly quota of projects.

As a practical recommendation, define the intended benefit before selecting the action. Otherwise management may celebrate implementation while remaining unable to assess improvement.

2. Control The Problem And Its Consequences - 10.2.1

When a nonconformity occurs, the organisation must respond and, where applicable, control and correct it and deal with the consequences.

Suppose a laboratory issues a report containing an incorrect result. Reissuing the report may correct the immediate output. The organisation still needs to consider what happened to the original report, who relied on it and whether other work is affected.

Containment limits exposure while the situation is assessed. Correction addresses the detected problem. Corrective action addresses causes to prevent recurrence or occurrence elsewhere. These activities can interact, but they serve different purposes.

The terminology should help people choose the response. It should not become an exercise in filling separate forms while an affected customer continues using unreliable information.

3. Evaluate The Need To Remove Causes

Clause 10.2.1 requires evaluation of the need for cause-removal action. That includes reviewing the nonconformity, determining its causes and checking whether similar problems exist or could occur elsewhere.

Proportionality matters. A full 8D investigation is not prescribed for every case. Equally, calling a problem minor does not justify automatically accepting correction as the complete response.

Record a defensible evaluation. Consider the effects, recurrence history, relevant circumstances and potential exposure elsewhere. Where further corrective action is unnecessary, the reasoning should withstand scrutiny.

When investigation is needed, choose methods that suit the problem. Five Whys, process mapping and cause-and-effect analysis can help, but completing a template does not verify a cause.

“Operator error” describes an event too broadly to explain why the process allowed it. Examine the instruction, interface, workload, competence, checks and actual sequence. Test the explanation against records and observations. Avoid assuming that every failure has one simple root cause.

4. Check The Same Exposure Elsewhere

An investigation limited to the original team may leave the same weakness operating in another location, shift or product family.

The required consideration is whether similar nonconformities exist or could occur. The extent of checking should follow the mechanism and consequences, rather than an arbitrary instruction to inspect everything.

For the incorrect report, compare relevant templates, transfer arrangements and review controls across similar reporting routes. The reason for selecting that population should be clear.

This is a practical investigation approach, not a universal requirement to review every historical report following every error.

5. Implement Action And Review Effectiveness

Necessary action must be implemented, and the effectiveness of corrective action must be reviewed. Risks, opportunities or the QMS need updating where necessary. Corrective action must suit the effects of the nonconformity.

Revising a procedure provides evidence of implementation. Reviewing representative subsequent work can provide evidence about effectiveness. An elapsed period without a repeat problem means little if the relevant activity has not occurred during that period.

Before implementation, agree what evidence would support effectiveness: the targeted failure, relevant operating conditions, observation period and evaluation method. These planning details are recommended controls, rather than a prescribed ISO checklist.

If the evidence contradicts the proposed cause, revisit the explanation. If the action has not worked, revise the response. Closing a record should not prevent the organisation from acknowledging an ineffective action.

Hypothetical Worked Example: The Backlog That Did Not Fall

A register begins the month with sixty open cases. Twenty close, fifteen new cases arrive and five previously closed cases reopen after failed effectiveness checks. Assume those reopened cases were outside the opening backlog and all movements count distinct cases.

The closing backlog is sixty: 60 minus 20 plus 15 plus 5. Reporting fifty-five would omit the reopened work.

Twenty closures demonstrate case movement. They do not demonstrate twenty effective improvements. The five reopenings also do not automatically establish a 25% failure rate among that month's closures: the reopened cases may belong to an earlier cohort.

To evaluate closure quality, follow a defined group of actions through the relevant effectiveness reviews. Account for cases not yet due for review and explain any exclusions.

6. Retain Evidence That Supports The Conclusion - 10.2.2

Documented information must be available about the nonconformity, subsequent actions and corrective action results.

A useful record connects the requirement and evidence of failure with immediate control, consequence assessment, cause evaluation, action and the effectiveness conclusion. Supporting evidence might include affected output records, technical checks, observations, revised controls and subsequent performance.

That is an illustrative evidence trail. The clause does not demand a document with each of those headings or a particular software workflow.

The Management Takeaway

Within 30 days, review ten corrective actions whose effectiveness checks are due. Report how many have a supported effectiveness conclusion, how many require further observation and how many need revised action. Assign responsibility for unresolved cases. This is a recommended management exercise, not an ISO sample-size requirement.

An auditor should ask whether the response matched the problem's effects, whether cause removal was properly evaluated and what evidence supports the result.

This closes our seven-day journey through Clauses 4-10. Context informs decisions, leadership directs them, planning selects actions, support enables delivery, operation applies controls and evaluation tests results. Improvement uses that learning to change what happens next.

Which closed action would you reopen today if its effectiveness had to be demonstrated rather than assumed?

DAY 7 / CLAUSE 10 / SUPPORTING POSTER 01

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 10

CORRECTION AND CORRECTIVE ACTION

CONTAINMENT

Limit exposure while the problem is assessed.

CORRECTION

Address the detected nonconformity.

CORRECTIVE ACTION

Address causes to prevent recurrence or occurrence elsewhere.



Evaluate the need for cause removal.
Match the response to the effects.

Practical guidance. A full 8D investigation is not required for every case.

www.rpgexcellence.com | Technical Insight / Poster 01

DAY 7 / CLAUSE 10 / SUPPORTING POSTER 02

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 10

THE ACTION IS COMPLETE. DID IT WORK?

DEFINE THE RESULT

What failure should the action prevent?

CHECK RELEVANT WORK

Has the process operated under the conditions that matter?

REVIEW THE EVIDENCE

Do records and observations support effectiveness?

DECIDE WHAT FOLLOWS

Confirm the result, extend observation or revise the action.



A closure date alone cannot demonstrate effectiveness.

Suggested review questions supporting Clause 10.2.1.
Adapt the method to the effects of the nonconformity.

www.rpgexcellence.com | Technical Insight / Poster 02

DAY 7 / CLAUSE 10 / SUPPORTING POSTER 03

RPG EXCELLENCE

ISO 9001:2026 / CLAUSE 10

WHAT CLOSURE FIGURES CAN HIDE

REOPENED CASES

Include failed effectiveness checks in the reporting picture.

REVIEWS STILL DUE

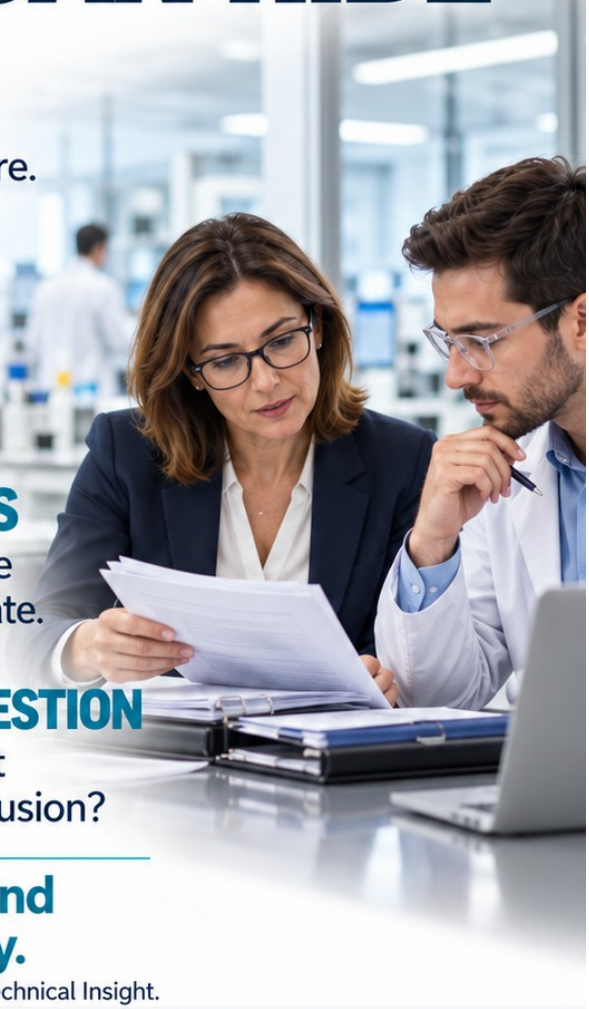
Separate completed actions from effectiveness reviews still outstanding.

COMPARABLE CASES

Follow a defined group before calculating an effectiveness rate.

THE MANAGEMENT QUESTION

What has improved, and what evidence supports that conclusion?



Report case movement and verified results separately.

Practical reporting guidance supporting the Day 7 Technical Insight.

www.rpgexcellence.com | Technical Insight / Poster 03

Sources and further reading

Technical basis

User-supplied licensed BS EN ISO 9001:2026, Clauses 4.1 to 10.2.2, with relevant informative Annex A explanations. Requirement descriptions are original paraphrases. The licensed standard is the authoritative source for the complete requirements.

RPG Excellence, Decoding ISO 9001:2026, supplied author publication. Relevant discussions appear on pages 6-27, with explanatory annex material. This collected edition develops the same emphasis on evidence and operating decisions.

Public references

ISO - ISO 9001:2026: What businesses need to know

https://www.iso.org/quality-management/iso-9001-2026

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BSI - ISO 9001:2026 key changes and guidance

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ISO and IAF - Joint Communique on Climate Change Amendments, February 2024

https://www.iso.org/files/live/sites/isoorg/files/standards/popular_standards/management_systems/ISO-IAF%20Joint%20Communique%20Feb%202024.pdf

Reading the sources

The clause numbering and technical interpretation follow the supplied published standard. Public overview wording may simplify requirements or retain draft references. Annex A is informative; an annex also existed in the 2015 edition. Climate relevance wording introduced by the 2024 amendment is not treated here as entirely new in 2026. No transition deadline is asserted in this collection.

Continue the discussion

Explore the RPG Excellence ISO 9001 guide, gap analysis and related publications at www.rpgexcellence.com/en/iso-9001. Use these resources to support informed implementation and review.